

Google's AI spam protection

How does scam detection for Messages in Android work?

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It's 2025, and scammers are out in full force, thanks in no small part to new GenAI tools that make them sound scarily convincing. They might pose as your friendly courier driver, bank's fraud department, or your telecom provider's customer care representative – and after just a few

unsuspecting messages or convincing small talk, their nefarious scheme can rob you blind. Against this backdrop, Google has just unveiled an AI-powered Scam Detection feature for Google Messages, aiming to shield Android users from malicious social engineering scams.

If you're reading this thinking you already have spam filters on your Android phone, you're not wrong. Google had spam protection for years. But so many criminals these days are using more advanced, more casual "conversation-style" approaches – a far cry from the old spam messages about winning some obscure lottery. Today's scams might start with a friendly hello and then, weeks later, ask you for personal info or lure you to switch to a suspicious messaging app. That's what Google wants to stop – the pivot from innocent to shady right in the middle of an ongoing chat.

Scamming is a huge industry. Some estimates put it at over \$1 trillion from mobile users alone – underscore the staggering scope of the problem. As arguably one of the largest gatekeepers for Android messages worldwide, if Google can stamp out mid-conversation scams, that's a big plus. The technology to do so, ironically, is also driven by AI advances.

In a blog post, Google highlights how crucial it was to partner with

